



4

1. The facade of El Celler de Can Roca restaurant
2. (From left) Jordi, Joan, and Josep Roca at the event
3. Petit Fours served after desserts
4. The limited edition "The Macallan Time:Space" bottle
5. A dish called "Nose to Tail," made from lamb



5

What followed was a 16-course journey that blurred the lines between gastronomy and art. There were no predictable pairings of whisky and food; instead, every dish wove the spirit of the drink into its essence.

The opening act was a veal consommé—a warm, earthy broth delicately laced with sherry and the umami depth of mushrooms. It arrived in bespoke glassware, etched with the unmistakable silhouettes of the Roca brothers, as if to remind you that even the tableware here is part of the experience.

Then came a course that reimagined The Macallan's distillery. Designed to resemble the estate's iconic rooftop, the dish featured three hidden snacks: malted oat brioche with brewer's yeast, horseradish and turnip, paired with a creamy cork distillate. Each bite was

crafted to evoke the feeling of strolling through the Scottish Highlands, minus the drizzle and the chill.

Next was 'Treasured Water,' a dish that danced onto the table as if it had wandered in from a David Blaine show. It arrived on a thermal plate, releasing aromatic steam that unveiled a concealed broth. Paired with The Macallan 18 Years, described by Diane Stuart, the Whisky Maker, as aged in Sherry oak casks from Spain with notes of dried fruit, toasted almonds, and baking spices.

As desserts approached, Jordi, the youngest brother and self-styled rebel of the trio, took over. Crowned the 'World's Best Pastry Chef', Jordi elevated the dessert courses to performance art. First, we were handed augmented reality glasses and transported on a virtual journey through the world of cacao, from Ecuador's lush plantations to Jordi's own chocolate factory. When the glasses came off, there it was: a single chocolate, macerated in Macallan whisky and crafted with 70% Ecuadorian cacao. It was a chocolate that had ambitions far beyond being eaten.

For the grand finale, Jordi unveiled the 'Angel's Tribute.' Using the Rocas' trademark VOM technique (Volatile Organic Memory), he conjured a cloud-like foam that floated dramatically through the air before gently settling on our desserts. As it descended, the foam transformed into drops of whisky, infusing the dish with sherry-sweet notes. This wasn't just a dessert; it was a poetic homage to the 'angel's share', the whisky lost to evaporation during ageing—combining science and artistry in a breathtaking presentation.

Just when we thought the performance was over, he returned, this time dressed in a kilt. He wheeled out a giant donut cake and with the flair of a medieval knight, sliced it open with a ceremonial sword. The pièce de résistance, however, was the whisky served alongside it: The Macallan Time: Space—a special edition commemorating the distillery's 200 years. Housed in a circular vessel that looked like it belonged in Guggenheim Museum, it was a collector's item priced at \$1,400 (or approx. ₹1,20,000) that underscored the exclusivity of the experience.

As I left the restaurant, I realised that the meal wasn't just about whisky heritage or the Rocas' culinary genius. It was a celebration of what happens when passion, artistry and magic come together. Dining with the Roca brothers isn't just about food—it's about theatre, memory and storytelling.

If you ever get the chance to dine at El Celler, take it—not for accolades or social media clout, but to witness how food can transcend the ordinary and become pure magic. **BT**

@RaajSanghvi